

CALIFORNIA CONTRACTOR EDITION

How to use BidXchange



A practical guide for California contractor teams

STEP-BY-STEP TRAINING • SEPTEMBER 2026

[Open BidXchange ↗](#)

One bid. One connected review trail.

01

Company → Opportunity

Record reusable company evidence. Capture the buyer's notice and official source.

02

Requirements → Decision → Tasks

Review the register, identify gaps, sign off and record human bid intent. Assign the remaining work.

03

Draft → Approval → Submission record

Prepare and review a specific response version. A person submits externally and records what happened.

BidXchange organizes the work. People determine eligibility, price, approve, sign and submit.

Create or join your company

01

Confirm your work email

Open /signup for a new account or /login to sign in. Use the confirmation link or email code.

02

Create or accept an invitation

Open /onboarding. Create a company you administer, or accept the invitation for your exact confirmed email.

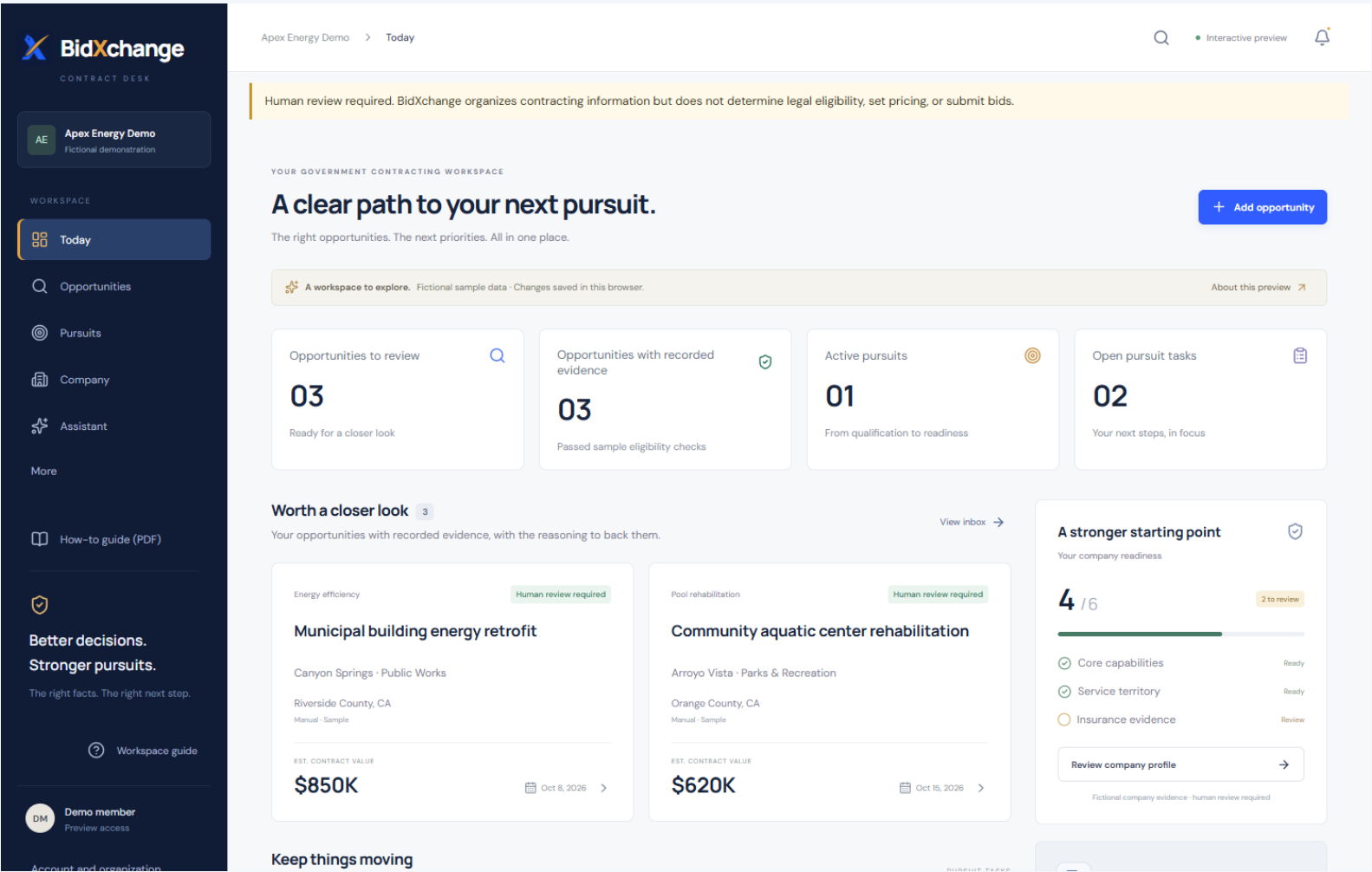
03

Follow the setup checklist

Open each Passport area, save supported evidence, then record your first opportunity. Confirm the selected company.

Use the fictional demo to explore navigation—not to store real company information.

Find your way around



Today

Start with deadlines, open work and evidence that needs attention.

Your bid workspace

Company: evidence.
Opportunities: notices.
Pursuits: reviews and drafts.

Assistant

Ask general questions or select
Workspace records for authorized
company context.

Live public-demo screenshot · all displayed company
and bid data are fictional.

Start with the Company Passport

01

Identity and registrations

Enter legal name, DBA, entity type and headquarters.
Record SAM/UEI and DIR status as claimed.

02

License, territory and services

Record CSLB number/classifications, expiration, counties or travel radius, and service/NAICS descriptions.

03

Coverage and experience

Add bonding bands, GL/workers' compensation/auto expiration dates, and three past projects.

Open Company → California Contractor Passport. Use “Add when needed” for advanced evidence.

Save evidence with a source

01

Add what you can support

Open the relevant Passport item. Enter the structured fields and a useful record label.

02

Keep its provenance

Record the source reference or note, dates, owner and permitted visibility. Save the evidence record.

03

Request human review

An authorized reviewer checks the claim and records attestation. Saving alone does not attest it.

A CSLB number in the Passport does not establish that its classification covers a particular bid.

Use the Radar before the next deadline

01

Choose a window

In Company or Today, filter the Radar: expired, 0–30, 31–60, 61–90 days, stale, or missing dates.

02

Open the record

Check the source, expiration and owner. Correct the evidence and obtain the required human review.

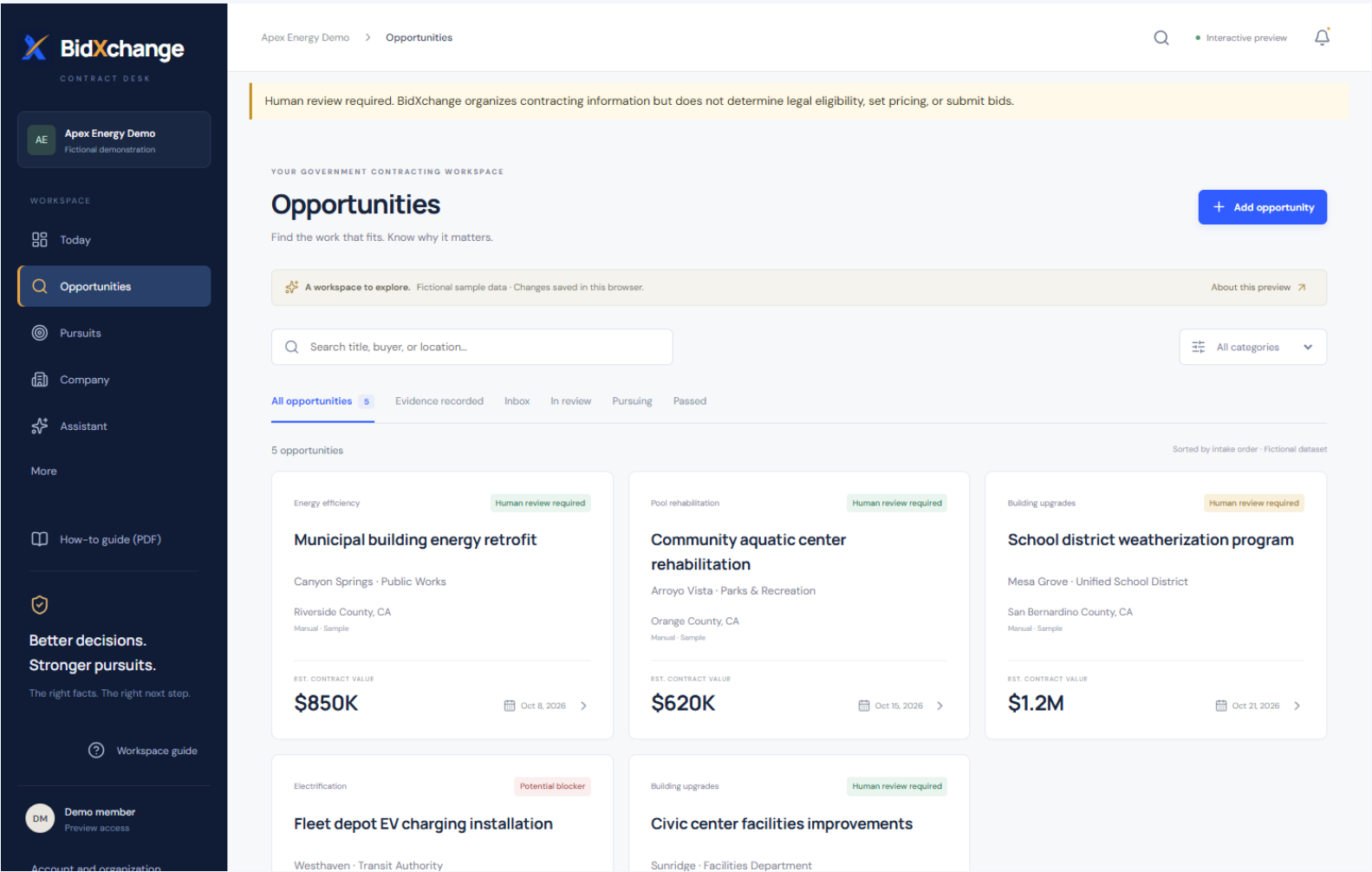
03

Revisit affected pursuits

Scheduled checks and pursuit access can reopen linked requirements. Review reminders and reaffirm stale decisions.

A reminder is not renewed coverage. Update and review the underlying evidence.

Capture the notice, not just its title



Record an opportunity

Enter buyer, title, solicitation number, source and notice excerpt.

Confirm the deadline

Record the exact date, time and time zone from official instructions.

Keep the source current

Preserve the portal URL and source-review note. Check for changes at the official site.

Live public-demo screenshot · fictional opportunities; not a live market feed.

Use official portals deliberately

01

Open a portal shortcut

Find official links for SAM.gov, Cal eProcure, SCE PEPMA, LADWP, LAUSD and other supported sources.

02

Research at the source

Sign in directly when required. Read the notice, attachments, meeting instructions and addenda.

03

Bring the evidence back

Save the official URL and source note in BidXchange. Paste the relevant public notice excerpt.

“External site” means a portal shortcut—not automatic synchronization or submission.

Turn an opportunity into a pursuit

01

Open the opportunity

Confirm the source notice and the opportunity you intend to evaluate.

02

Start the pursuit

Use the opportunity's pursuit/planning control. Give the workspace a recognizable name.

03

Work in that pursuit

Keep requirements, decision history, tasks, response drafts and release records together.

Starting a pursuit is a planning step. It is not a final decision to bid.

Extract candidate requirements

01

Paste a notice excerpt

Use the notice-review area in the pursuit. Include a source reference and relevant original wording.

02

Inspect the suggestions

Check candidate requirements and the California checklist heuristics against the quoted source.

03

Save only what applies

Add/edit cited requirements. Fill omissions manually; dismiss irrelevant suggestions.

Candidate requirements may be incomplete or inaccurate until a person reviews and signs off.

Review each requirement and its evidence

01

Keep a traceable row

Check requirement wording and citation. Assign an owner and record clarification needs.

02

Review evidence use

Choose the company evidence. Assess applicability and whether it is approved for this requirement.

03

Record a human finding

Use supported, blocked, awaiting clarification, needs review or not applicable—with a reason.

A saved company fact is not automatically approved evidence for this pursuit.

Sign off the register before deciding

01

Review beyond the extracted rows

Check for missing forms, dates, job walks, bonds, addenda and submission instructions.

02

Record the sign-off

Open Requirements Register sign-off. Enter a review note and confirm the acknowledgment.

03

Refresh the review context

A current human sign-off enables final bid/no-bid recording. Review outstanding gaps explicitly.

Sign-off records a person's review. It does not certify eligibility or erase blockers.

Write a bid/no-bid decision memo

01

Before final review

Use Draft decision, Leaning bid or Leaning pass when the team is still investigating.

02

When ready to decide

Choose Pursue bid or Do not bid after sign-off. Record rationale, primary reason and pursuit hours.

03

Keep the limits visible

Document conditions and unresolved risks. Confirm the scope of your authority and save.

Pursuit hours are entered by a person. There is no profitability or win-probability score.

Assign the contractor work

01

Use the task template

Offer tasks for DIR, bond requests, job walks, wages, payroll, quotes, addenda and submission checks.

02

Make each task actionable

Assign an owner, due date/time zone, priority and notes. Link the relevant requirement.

03

Update the work

Move tasks through todo, in progress and complete. Resolve blockers with documented human review.

A confirmed capability gap can become an “Identify a teaming partner for...” task.

Use the assistant in the right mode

01

General questions

Ask “Explain how a bid bond works.” This mode does not read private company records.

02

Workspace records

Select the company context.
Ask “Summarize this pursuit”
or “What tasks are overdue?”
Review its sources.

03

Document command

Open the pursuit and ask:
“Create a response outline for
this solicitation”. A register
must exist.

The assistant can organize and explain. It cannot approve, price, sign, certify or submit.

Create the response outline

01

Create or open the draft

In Response packages, choose Create response draft—or open the assistant-created response.

02

Check the autofill preview

Inspect company and bid information. Current attested records may fill allowed fields; gaps stay visible.

03

Write the actual response

Complete the overview and each requirement answer. Human input is required for pricing and technical content.

Missing, stale or restricted evidence must not become an invented statement.

Review and export the saved draft

01

Save the latest edits

Complete the overview and requirement answers. Remove every unfinished human-input marker.

02

Inspect the saved response

Review missing answers, changed requirements and stale source context. Read the document end to end.

03

Download a review copy

Choose Download saved draft PDF or Download saved draft Word from the saved response card.

A downloaded working draft is not an approved release or proof of submission.

Approve one specific response version

01

Complete release checks

Confirm instructions, attachments, deadline, portal and named submitter. Prepare the required final files.

02

Freeze the reviewed version

Use the versioned release workflow and final-file manifest. Keep final files in approved storage.

03

Record the required approvals

Authorized reviewers complete the available gates in order. Recheck if the draft or context changes.

Approvals belong to the exact version. Editing requires a new version and renewed review.

Submit externally, then record the receipt

01

Use the official destination

The named person submits through the buyer portal, email or other stated delivery method.

02

Record what actually happened

Confirm the exact files and enter the actual time, method, confirmation number and receipt reference.

03

Preserve the trail

Retain the approved version and external receipt. Add a correction rather than rewriting history.

Submission information is user-recorded and is not independently verified by BidXchange.

Handle amendments and stale evidence

01

Record the amendment

Add its label, date, official URL, summary and public excerpt in Opportunity amendments.

02

Review the official change

Read it at the source. Record human amendment review; update affected requirements and tasks.

03

Reaffirm the work

Re-sign the register, record a fresh decision and prepare a new release version when context changes.

Previous sign-offs and decisions remain in history. A new amendment requires fresh review.

Close the loop—and know who can act

01

Record the outcome

Open Post-submission follow-up. Record an award, loss or cancellation with date, official source, reason and debrief.

02

Use the right role

Admins manage company evidence/access. Capture managers organize bids and drafts. Approvers review decisions/releases.

03

If a control is missing

Check organization and role. Refresh changed records. Ask your administrator for the appropriate access.

An award or past-performance claim must come from a documented human record.

Practice with one fictional training bid

01

Set up the example

In an authorized training workspace, label it “TRAINING — not for submission”. Cite a numbered training brief.

02

Build the review trail

Add two requirements, one clarification and one assigned task. Review evidence and record a preliminary decision.

03

Prepare a reviewable draft

Create an outline. Complete one answer, leave one placeholder, export and explain why it is not approved.

Practice success: another team member can trace an answer back to its requirement and evidence.

Make it a daily operating routine

01

Start in Today

Check deadlines, overdue tasks, blockers and evidence needing attention. Open active pursuits.

02

Check before handoff

Is the register signed off? Is the decision current? Are answers complete and this exact version approved?

03

Keep learning

Use Workspace guide for contextual help. Open the official source whenever instructions are uncertain.

Open bidxapp.vercel.app → choose your company → take the next documented action.

Use the thirteen-step pursuit checklist

01

Open it inside a pursuit

Choose ?Open this pursuit?s workflow checklist.? Each step links to the relevant record or control.

02

Follow the current records

Requirements sign-off comes before a final bid/no-bid decision. A current no-bid stops response recommendations.

03

Read the status carefully

Recorded means a saved record exists. It does not mean eligible, compliant or submitted by BidXchange.

A changed source or evidence record can require renewed human review.

Rehearse the complete review sequence

01

Open the municipal retrofit

In the demo, choose Practice the municipal retrofit bid. Renew the sample insurance and review ten requirements.

02

Record the review trail

Add review notes, sign off, record a reasoned decision and finish the three assigned training tasks.

03

Test what changes

Create an outline, replace placeholders with fictional text, approve and record a fictional receipt. Then simulate an amendment.

Fictional local exercise only. Nothing is submitted or saved to a company.

Correct the register without losing history

01

Archive an incorrect row

Open Archive or merge requirement. Choose archive, explain why and confirm. The original stays in Archived requirements.

02

Merge duplicate requirements

Choose an active target in the same pursuit and review the combined wording. Both citations are preserved; the source is archived.

03

Restore for another review

Open an archived row and choose Restore requirement. The original returns as needs review. Review any merged target separately.

Corrections require fresh sign-off and approval. Archiving is not a buyer waiver.